

Process Scénarisation

Dropshipping Automation Project — Before / After

How to read this

The scenarisation describes the business process step by step, identifying for each step **who does what** (actor → task). It is presented in two versions: **BEFORE** — the current manual process, and **AFTER** — the automated n8n pipeline.

BEFORE — The Manual Process (AS-IS)

Product discovery and research

- **Seller** → scrolls social media for hours looking for viral products.
- **Seller** → notes down products people seem to want in a spreadsheet.
- **Seller** → searches Amazon, Alibaba, and AliExpress manually for each product.
- **Seller** → compares prices, reviews, and shipping times by hand.
- **Seller** → decides by gut feeling which product is worth selling.

Store and marketing

- **Seller** → creates the product page on the website manually.
- **Seller** → writes social media posts and edits videos by hand.
- **Seller** → publishes posts one by one on each platform, irregularly.

Sales and after-sales

- **Seller** → receives an order by email and copies it to the supplier's site.
- **Supplier** → ships the product and sends the tracking number by email.
- **Seller** → manually copies the tracking number to the customer.
- **Customer** → asks questions or requests a refund by email.
- **Seller** → replies manually and negotiates refunds case by case.

Pain points

- Slow — days of work per product.
- Subjective — decisions based on gut feeling.
- Repetitive — endless copy-paste between sites and emails.
- Reactive — trends are often missed before they peak.
- Inconsistent — posting and customer replies happen only when the seller has time.

AFTER — The Automated Process (TO-BE)

Each cron run follows this sequence (daily / weekly / monthly, as configured by the owner):

1. Discovery and research

- **Scheduler** → triggers the pipeline at the configured time (daily / weekly / monthly).
- **Listening Agent** → scans X, Facebook, and Instagram comments for "where can I buy this?" patterns.
- **Listening Agent** → outputs a ranked list of products people already want.
- **Research Agent** → matches each product against Amazon, Alibaba, and AliExpress listings.
- **Research Agent** → extracts price, reviews, shipping time, and profit margin per product.
- **Scoring Agent** → ranks products by demand, margin, trend, and competition.
- **Scoring Agent** → outputs a validated shortlist, skipping already-published items.

2. Marketing and publishing

- **Content Agent** → generates social media posts and short videos per product.
- **Content Agent** → schedules and publishes them on the store's accounts.
- **Publishing Agent** → inserts the trending products into the website database (products table + publish log).
- **Website** → auto-lists the new products directly from the database — no code change, no deploy.
- **Reporting Agent** → sends the owner a run digest: products found, items added, errors.

3. Sales and after-sales

- **Customer** → discovers a post, visits the store, and places an order.
- **Fulfillment Agent** → captures the order and forwards it to the supplier automatically.
- **Supplier** → ships the product; the tracking number is pulled back automatically.
- **Fulfillment Agent** → sends the tracking number and confirmation email to the customer.
- **Care Agent** → auto-replies to FAQs and processes refund requests per supplier policy.
- **Care Agent** → collects reviews and feeds performance data back to the Scoring Agent (feedback loop).

Key Differences at a Glance

- **Research:** from hours of scrolling to social listening + data-driven scoring.
- **Publishing:** from manual page creation to a simple database insert the website picks up automatically.
- **Marketing:** from hand-written, irregular posts to AI-generated, scheduled, multi-platform content.

- **Orders:** from copy-paste to fully automatic forwarding and tracking updates.
- **Support:** from delayed manual replies to instant automated answers.
- **Owner's role:** from full-time operator to configuration and monitoring only.
- **Speed:** from days per product to one cron cycle — trends are caught early.